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NJ Transit Quietly Scales Back Ambitious \$22 Million Bus Lane After World Cup

By Shore News Network Staff Report / July 28, 2026



Newark, NJ – A new NJ TRANSIT after-action report on transportation operations during the FIFA World Cup does **not** cancel the long-discussed Meadowlands Transitway. Instead, the report concludes that future events at NJNY Stadium can be effectively managed using existing transportation infrastructure without the extraordinary level of service deployed during the international tournament.

The report, released July 21, reviews transportation operations for all eight FIFA World Cup matches hosted at the stadium and describes the effort as the largest event transportation operation in New Jersey history. According to NJ TRANSIT, more than 370,000 event-related passengers were transported during the 39-day tournament.

Report says existing system can meet future demand

Rather than recommending new permanent transit infrastructure, NJ TRANSIT concluded that future stadium events should not require transportation commitments exceeding 20,000 passengers within a two-hour operating window.

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operating window,” the report states.

The agency also concluded that the Meadowlands will remain primarily automobile-oriented.

“The stadium’s suburban location and an anchored regional suburban mall with a combined 28,000 parking spaces, will continue to generate substantial private vehicle demand and associated parking requirements,” the report says. “As such, the area is not expected to evolve into a truly transit-oriented environment, and automobile access will remain a primary mode of travel.”

No indication the Transitway project has been canceled

The after-action report does not state that the Meadowlands Transitway has been canceled. It also does not announce any decision by Governor Mikie Sherrill’s administration, NJ TRANSIT’s Board of Directors, or the New Jersey Department of Transportation to terminate the project.

Instead, the report focuses on operational lessons learned during the World Cup and recommends that future stadium transportation rely on existing rail infrastructure, with dedicated bus operations used only when needed.

“Accordingly, NJ TRANSIT can continue supporting future stadium events through existing infrastructure,” the report states. It adds that “dedicated bus operations should be reserved for rail contingencies and deployed at NJ TRANSIT’s discretion as needed.”

World Cup transportation deemed a success

NJ TRANSIT credited the success of the tournament to coordination with the New Jersey Turnpike Authority, New Jersey Department of Transportation, Port Authority of New York and New Jersey, Amtrak, New Jersey State Police, and numerous local, state, and federal agencies.

The agency said it successfully transported all ticketed passengers despite severe weather, extreme heat, and s

While the report recommends scaling back future event operations based on demonstrated demand, it stops short of eliminating any planned transportation projects. Any decision to formally cancel or modify the Meadowlands Transitway would require a separate announcement by state officials.

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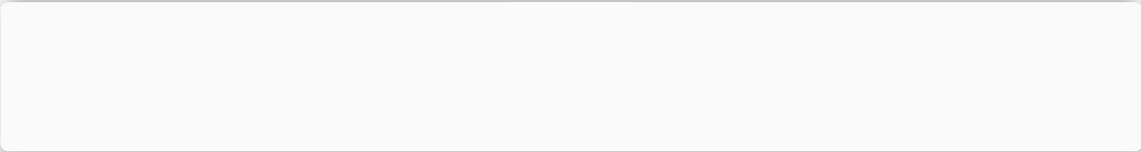
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